Alaska K-12 AI Framework: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *Alaska's Strategic Framework: Artificial Intelligence for K-12, Recommendations and Considerations for Districts (Alaska Department of Education & Early Development, State Board October 2025)*. Page numbers match the document's own page numbering. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text. The Security principle appears on page 4 as one column of a summary graphic and again in full on page 9; only the page 9 version is quoted. The Data Governance passage on page 7 is marked [graphic] because the PDF text layer renders "AI" as "AI"; it was transcribed from the rendered page.

Purpose and Scope (excerpt)

Source: page 3

This framework aims to foster innovation, enhance learning outcomes, and safeguard student well-being and data privacy, ultimately contributing to the state's overarching goal of providing an excellent education for every student every day.

This framework complements existing local policies on technology use, data protection, academic integrity, and student support.

Transparency: Data Governance

Source: page 7 [graphic]

[graphic] Districts should carefully review AI vendors to ensure tools meet rigorous privacy and security standards before adoption. This includes ensuring vendors provide clear privacy and compliance documentation for review.

Transparency: Communication Strategy (excerpt)

Source: page 7

Districts should develop a clear communication plan for disseminating AI guidelines to all stakeholders, transparently outlining benefits, safety measures, privacy protocols, and data management procedures.

Oversight: Vendor Accountability and Review

Source: page 8

Accountability extends to the partners and vendors who provide AI tools. Districts should carefully review AI vendors to ensure tools meet rigorous privacy and security standards before they are adopted for classroom use.

Security

Source: page 9

Rigorous protection of student data and digital well-being is non-negotiable. This includes protocols against unauthorized sharing of Personally Identifiable Information (PII) and compliance with local, state, and federal laws. The integration of AI introduces new opportunities and potential vulnerabilities. A proactive and robust security posture is essential to protect student data, maintain the integrity of district systems, and build trust within the community.

Cybersecurity

Districts must prioritize cybersecurity to protect computer systems and networks from information disclosure, theft, or damage to data, and disruption of services. This demands a strategic approach to building necessary skills for IT managers and establishing security monitoring.

Protecting Personally Identifiable Information (PII)

Users must be taught the importance of protecting data privacy when using generative AI tools. Explicit prohibitions against entering sensitive student data, PII, or confidential information into publicly accessible AI tools are essential.

Compliance with Laws

Districts must ensure that any AI tools procured or used comply rigorously with federal laws such as the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), and the Children's Internet Protection Act (CIPA).

Vendor Vetting

Districts should establish a robust vetting process for AI tools, requiring schools and districts to review terms of service, privacy policies, and compliance documentation from vendors. Proactive guidance helps ensure that recommended tools adhere to high data privacy and security standards.

Actionable Steps for Districts

Districts should take actionable steps to create a robust security posture for generative AI.

- Review and amend existing data privacy and acceptable use policies to address the unique risks of generative AI.
- Establish simple "Do's and Don'ts" for daily AI use, such as using anonymized data in prompts and never uploading documents containing confidential school or district information.

Ethical Use: Comprehensive Training Strategy (excerpt)

Source: page 10

Districts should develop a comprehensive training strategy covering ethical and responsible AI use, including data privacy and academic integrity.

Definitions: Personally Identifiable Information (PII)

Source: page 13

Personally Identifiable Information (PII): Information that directly or indirectly identifies an individual (e.g., name, student ID, address).